



Hustle Badger

Press Release & FAQs [Title]

This is the Hustle Badger template for an Amazon style Press Release & FAQs (PR/FAQs) template.

It is heavily indebted to Ian McAllister's posts on [Quora](#) & [LinkedIn](#).

How to use:

1. Make your own copy
2. All text in *italic* is placeholder.
3. You should put the title of the feature above, and also delete this box.

Read the full guide to the Amazon Working Backwards Process [here](#).

Best practice in constructing an Amazon style Press Release:

1. Write from a future, hypothetical perspective. It's 18 months in the future, and your watercooler idea is now reality. Write that vision.
2. Keep it to 1.5 pages or below
3. Each paragraph should be 3-4 sentences long
4. Avoid fat
5. This is not a product spec - the FAQ section (Internal) is the place to put business or execution questions & answers
6. Avoid internal acronyms, language or phrasing common to your function.
7. Imagine that you are a television presenter - and write in their voice. This should be done as though broadcasting to millions of people who have no prior understanding or knowledge of your product. Make it simple, compelling and intelligible.



Press Release:

Heading

Name the product in a way the reader (i.e. your target customers) will understand.

This is a standard press release title. Ian McAllister recommends this format: [COMPANY] ANNOUNCES [SERVICE | TECHNOLOGY | TOOL] TO ENABLE [CUSTOMER SEGMENT] TO [BENEFIT STATEMENT]. If you don't like that one, go onto the press sections of big companies and take a look at how they're composing their titles.

Example:

"CIRCULERT APP ALERTS SHOPPERS WHEN THE PRODUCTS AND SERVICES THEY WANT BECOME AVAILABLE OR DROP IN PRICE"

Sub-Heading

Describe who the market for the product is and what benefit they get.

One sentence only underneath the title. This should frame the main announcement in a slightly different way. You can add a little more detail.

Date

This is the date you could potentially launch the product.

Recommendation: build in buffer, in case the CEO who just signed it off excitedly now hardcodes that date in their calendar.

Example:

"SEATTLE-January 1, 2025 - Circulert, a Seattle company, today launched a new application for iOS and Android that notifies users when the products and services they want or need become available for sale or drop in price. "

Problem

Describe the problem your product solves.

Lay out the top 3-4 (max) problems for the customers your product or service is intended to serve. Describe each problem briefly and talk about the negative impact of it. Leave your solution aside, it's coming later. Be laser focused on the problem statement, and make sure the problems are ranked in descending order of pain. Top problem = the worst problem, last problem = the least painful problem.

Example:

"Many items consumers want to buy aren't available today, or the price might not be quite sharp enough to prompt a purchase. If there's a specific brand of clothing you like, you have to keep checking retailer websites so see if they've released a new line, or spend time looking through a slew of daily emails from



every retailer you've ever shopped from to find the one email that tells you about new products you care about. How often have you found out that your favorite band is playing a show in your town after all the tickets are sold out? How often have you picked through "web specials" of your favorite clothing line when they go on discount, only to find that the only sizes still available of that one product you love are XXL or XXS? Too often."

Summary

Give a summary of the product and the benefit.

This has to be your killer paragraph. It's the most important one in the whole press release, as it's the one most people will read, and which has to bowl them over. Spend your time here first. This should be 3-4 sentences that expands upon the service / technology / tool that will help your customers laid out in the title.

Example:

"Circulert solves these problems by telling you when you can buy the things you want, or buy the things you want at the price you want. No more work. No more missing out. Circulert learns about the products and services you care most about, and then sends you only the notifications you want. You can choose the notification style or frequency, or view a feed of recent alerts. You are in control. "

Solution

Describe how your product/service elegantly solves the problem.

Summarise briefly how it works, and then go through the problem statement and describe how it fixes the problems individually and collectively.

Example:

"At launch, Circulert can send you availability or price drop notifications for products like clothing, music, or books from your favorite brands, artists or authors. Circulert can also tell you when your favorite band schedules a show in your town, when a flight between you and your long-distance partner is a screaming deal, or when the price of that sweet new tech bauble drops below the amount your spouse is likely to notice on the credit card statement."

Quote from the company

A [fake] quote from a spokesperson in your company

Pick a leader in your company and make up a quote that talks about why the company decided to tackle this problem and (at a high-level) how the solution solves it.

Example:

"Our goal with Circulert is to take the hassle out of buying things later," said Ian McAllister, creator of Circulert. "There are tens of thousands of retailers on the web selling everything imaginable. Circulert helps consumers filter out the noise



and all the stuff they don't need, and helps them get the things they do need at the best price, saving them time and money."

How the product/service works

Describe what a customer has to do to start using the product/service and how it works.

Go into enough detail to give them confidence it actually solves the problem and explain how the customer can use the service.

Example:

"To try out Circulert, go to Ciculert.com and download the app for iOS or Android. Connect the app to your Amazon, Ticketmaster, and other online accounts, and then review the suggested alerts. Circulert will then send you only highly relevant notifications when the items you want are available at the right price. You can star items that you want to get back to easily, share them with friends and family, or follow through and buy them."

Customer Quote

Provide a quote from a hypothetical customer that describes how they experienced the benefit.

Create a fake quote by a fake customer, but one that sounds like it could be real. The customer should describe their need or pain point, and then how your product or service fixes it.

Example:

"I absolutely hate missing out on a great deal," said Clare Keating, a nurse in Seattle. "To make sure I don't miss out I used to have to hit my favorite websites every few days. With Circulert, I found out about great deals right away and never miss out."

How to Get Started

Describe how easy it is to get started.

Provide a URL or other information on how a customer can access the product/service.

Example:

"If you want to save time or money (or both!), visit circulert.com today."



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Full Example Press Release:

[By Ian McAllister - full post [here](#)]

CIRCULERT APP ALERTS SHOPPERS WHEN THE PRODUCTS AND SERVICES THEY WANT BECOME AVAILABLE OR DROP IN PRICE

If a product or service isn't available today or at the right price, Circulert helps shoppers buy it later, for less.

SEATTLE-January 1, 2021 - Circulert, a Seattle company, today launched a new application for iOS and Android that notifies users when the products and services they want or need become available for sale or drop in price.

Many items consumers want to buy aren't available today, or the price might not be quite sharp enough to prompt a purchase. If there's a specific brand of clothing you like, you have to keep checking retailer websites so see if they've released a new line, or spend time looking through a slew of daily emails from every retailer you've ever shopped from to find the one email that tells you about new products you care about. How often have you found out that your favorite band is playing a show in your town after all the tickets are sold out? How often have you picked through "web specials" of your favorite clothing line when they go on discount, only to find that the only sizes still available of that one product you love are XXL or XXS? Too often.

Ciculert solves these problems by telling you when you can buy the things you want, or buy the things you want at the price you want. No more work. No more missing out. Circulert learns about the products and services you care most about, and then sends you only the notifications you want. You can choose the notification style or frequency, or view a feed of recent alerts. You are in control. At launch, Circulert can send you availability or price drop notifications for products like clothing, music, or books from your favorite brands, artists or authors. Circulert can also tell you when your favorite band schedules a show in your town, when a flight between you and your long-distance partner is a screaming deal, or when the price of that sweet new tech bauble drops below the amount your spouse is likely to notice on the credit card statement.

"Our goal with Circulert is to take the hassle out of buying things later," said Ian McAllister, creator of Circulert. "There are tens of thousands of retailers on the web selling everything imaginable. Circulert helps consumers filter out the noise and all the stuff they don't need, and helps them get the things they do need at the best price, saving them time and money."



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To try out Circulert, go to Circulert.com and download the app for iOS or Android. Connect the app to your Amazon, Ticketmaster, and other online accounts, and then review the suggested alerts. Circulert will then send you only highly relevant notifications when the items you want are available at the right price. You can star items that you want to get back to easily, share them with friends and family, or follow through and buy them.

"I absolutely hate missing out on a great deal," said Clare Keating, a nurse in Seattle. "To make sure I don't miss out I used to have to hit my favorite websites every few days. With Circulert, I found out about great deals right away and never miss out."

If you want to save time or money (or both!), visit circulert.com today.



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External FAQs

Where do I get the product?

Put where the user can find the product, i.e. It's available at www.pressreleaseImadeupthisweek.com/product

How much does it cost?

Put the price that the user will pay to access the product or service. I.e. It's free to use with in-app upsells for digital merchandise

How does it work?

Explain how the product works from the perspective of a customer. I.e. it's a free to use gaming app where you compete to take over the evil empire



Internal FAQs

Who is the customer?

Describe the end consumer of your product. If using personas, be sure to include quantitative elements as well, such as how many of them exist and in which geography / income bracket / demographic segment they exist.

How many consumers have this problem?

Here you need to size the market at a high level. This is a proxy for the size of the prize at stake. It could be a small problem that lots of people have, or a big problem that a few people have. Both can be viable problem areas to solve.

How big is the need / what is the TAM (total addressable market) of this problem?

This goes a little deeper on the previous question. Once you drill into the segment facing this problem, you need to figure out whether it is a large enough problem that enough people actually care about. Take customized shoes as an example. Most people in the United States wear shoes. Most people have some issues with their shoes; i.e. they don't fit quite correctly, or the design isn't quite perfect for their individual tastes. But how many people actually want to solve this problem by moving to entirely personalized shoes?

Why does this problem need to be solved now?

This is a timing question. Needs a compelling answer, which reflects customer need, size of opportunity and competitive landscape, rather than a roadmapping answer such as 'We're touching this section of the code at this time'.

For how many consumers is this problem big enough that they would be willing to spend money to do something about it?

Taking our shoe example again, we discover that there is a segment of people where customization of footwear is a large enough problem. Examples include hikers and skiers. So now the job is to figure out what percentage of those segments might be prepared to spend (time) and money on customization. Ideally this would be a mix of quantitative and qualitative evidence, i.e. 'The customizable shoe market in the US has increased 5% YoY for the last 6 years, driven by increasing ease of customization and decreasing cost of customization' and 'We asked XX customers whether they were interested in customizable shoe products & this is what we learned'.

If so, how much money would they be willing to spend?

Need <> price <> TAM are closely connected questions. In essence this question is both a discovery question, and it's a safety valve on the previous two questions. It's ensuring that you've thought through the customer's needs and the TAM



correctly. But also it helps lead the reviewer on to whether this product might be viable from a company resourcing and ROI perspective. You should include the future price per unit of the product & the pricing rationale - why you think people would be prepared to pay this price.

How many of these consumers have the characteristics/capabilities/constraints necessary to make use of the product?

This is a mix of TAM, useability & pricing thinking. For example, if the product costs \$1m, even if it's a product which is as commonly needed worldwide as, say, loaves of bread, the total market for the product will be small. Equally well if the product costs \$5, is as commonly needed worldwide as, say, loaves of bread, but you can only access the product on the moon, or via having access to '000s of servers, it's unlikely to get many customers. You need to answer why and how consumers will be able to access your solution at the price point you're proposing.

How can you support your answers?

Include links to all your research here.

What is the ROI of the project?

Items to include

- A P&L outline of the project based on
 - Cost of the project
 - Team cost fully loaded for overheads
 - Time to build the product
 - Time to payback
 - Units required to pay back the project
 - Including unit economics
 - Gross margin per unit
 - Cost per unit

This is to ensure that you're thinking through the value to the company in investing in this project, and understand the customer value proposition correctly. It's recommended that before you invest the time here that you nail the problem and solution statements, and spend some time discussing the idea with others to get feedback.

What are the likely product specifications?

Describe here what the product is, how it will work, and what it will take to build. Include mock ups if it makes sense to do so. Similarly to the P&L, it's advisable to invest time in mockups later on in the iteration cycle.

What is the flaw in your solution? What might disappoint the customer?

This is a good place to acknowledge any imperfections or flaws. I.e. this solves problem 1 and 2 that the customer has, but doesn't totally solve number 3.



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How will consumers discover the product?

This is the place to think about the Go-To-Market strategy. I.e. Consumers will be able to find this on the app store and therefore it will need support from the mobile marketing and organic search teams.

Are there any dependencies on other products or services in our ecosystem?

Here's the place to admit if you need the Payments team to set up a new gateway, if you need support from Legal, if you want an in-product bridge from other product or service.